Programmer loves programming - develops too much code for a report that will never see the light of day

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Overall Plan

I jumped on the idea of creating the project slightly before I began choosing a supervisor, so in my free time I started setting up the project and making a mental plan on what I will be able to immediately implement.

Mistake

I hadn't actually read the spec top to bottom, and only later realised that the marking will be on the perceived feasibility of the project. It is infeasible to build the whole application, as I had started with the business idea of publishing it as a consumer-focused application, as it was the most viable use case.

Pivoting to Lie Theory

I was originally going to develop a framework for user entry. It would allow a developer (me) to rapidly reset and compare various prompts, and I had slated the aspect of “the LLM will be in a different configuration after every prompt run” for later to discuss and address.

The Lie theory approach was supposed to solve this with running the model and instead inquiring it about its abilities, to benchmark not its stability as a software, but instead its performance as an aid in aiding the construction of a software project, plotted against the total collection of prompts used to produce text, counted against “resets” being new conversations, reboots, etc.

Limitation 1

I hadn't constructed an application or a software to produce a tally of the resets, which rendered this approach impossible. Instead I decided to attempt to write an application which instead would estimate the power use for the AI runner, in an attempt to produce a graphical readout of the *cost* of running such an AI in an office or a home setting. The intent would be to make the benefits of AI coding measurable for future applications, scientific or business-adjacent.

Limitation 2

Graphing in my native ecosystem, Java, is limited to a very particular look and feel. While I am familiar with developing for it,

I needed to write an application that would keep track of all the statistics for the project report. Which became apparent suddenly to be impossible, as I'd have to backtrack all my findings in utilising the LLM for research, and recall all of those metrics using this application, as my prompting style had changed during the term so far.